BY ENCHANTED MEDICAL AESTHETICS

THE GUT HEALTH RESET

Reduce Bloating, Support Digestion &
Restore Balance with Food-First Strategies



www.enchantedmedicalaesthetics.com

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WELCOME

I'm Dr. Bridget Martin, a Doctor of Nursing Practice and founder of Enchanted Medical Aesthetics. I'm passionate about helping individuals support digestion, restore balance, and feel their best through simple, realistic nutrition.

This guide was created to make gut health feel clear, practical, and easier to apply in everyday life. It is designed to help you better understand your gut, recognize what may be disrupting it, and build supportive habits that nourish digestion and overall well-being.



Inside, you'll find a modern, food-first approach to gut health, including clear education, actionable strategies, supportive tools, and a structured reset plan to help reduce bloating, support microbiome balance, and create more digestive ease.

The goal of this guide is not perfection. It is to help you take realistic, consistent steps that support a healthier gut and help you feel better from the inside out.

Let's connect!

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WHAT GUT HEALTH REALLY MEANS

A practical foundation for digestion, balance, and the microbiome

Gut health refers to how well your digestive system breaks down food, absorbs nutrients, and supports the lining of the intestines. It also reflects how the gut works with the immune system, metabolism, and nervous system. When this system works well, it supports comfort, regularity, and overall resilience.

At the center of gut health is the microbiome, a community of bacteria and other microorganisms that live mainly in the large intestine. These microbes support digestion, help protect the gut barrier, and influence immune and inflammation balance. A healthy gut is about keeping this internal environment balanced and resilient.

Gut health is shaped by daily habits such as food choices, sleep, movement, stress, and medication use. Over time, these factors can influence the microbiome and gut barrier, which is why steady, realistic habits matter more than quick fixes.

Did you know?

A large share of the body's immune activity is linked to the gut, where the microbiome and intestinal barrier work closely with immune cells to help protect overall health, support immune defense, and maintain balance in the body.

THE GUT MICROBIOME EXPLAINED

How gut microbes support overall health

Your gut microbiome is a dynamic community of microorganisms that live mainly in your large intestine. These microbes support digestion, help protect the gut lining, and play an important role in how your body processes nutrients and maintains internal balance.

This ecosystem is constantly influenced by your daily habits. Food choices, stress, sleep, and lifestyle patterns can all shape the composition of your microbiome, affecting how well it supports digestion, immune function, and overall gut stability.

Main microbiome location
Most gut bacteria live here and help maintain balance

Microbial diversity
A variety of bacteria supports resilience and stability



Nutrient absorption
Where nutrients are absorbed and supported by gut activity

Key insight

A diverse microbiome is often linked to better gut resilience, helping the body adapt more effectively to changes in diet and lifestyle.

WHY GUT HEALTH MATTERS BEYOND DIGESTION

How your gut influences key systems in the body

Immune Function

A large part of the immune system is closely connected to the gut. A balanced gut environment helps support immune defense and healthy immune responses.

Inflammation Balance

The gut helps regulate inflammation throughout the body. When the microbiome is balanced, it can help keep inflammatory signals more stable.

Nutrient Absorption

The gut is responsible for breaking down food and absorbing essential nutrients. Healthy gut function supports better use of vitamins, minerals, and other key compounds.

Brain & Mood Connection

The gut and brain are closely linked through the gut-brain axis. Changes in gut health may influence mood, stress response, and mental clarity.

Metabolic Health

The microbiome plays a role in how the body processes nutrients and manages energy. A balanced gut environment can help support overall metabolic function.



- Gut health is influenced by daily habits, not single foods
- Small, consistent changes can support long-term balance
- A diverse diet helps promote a more resilient microbiome

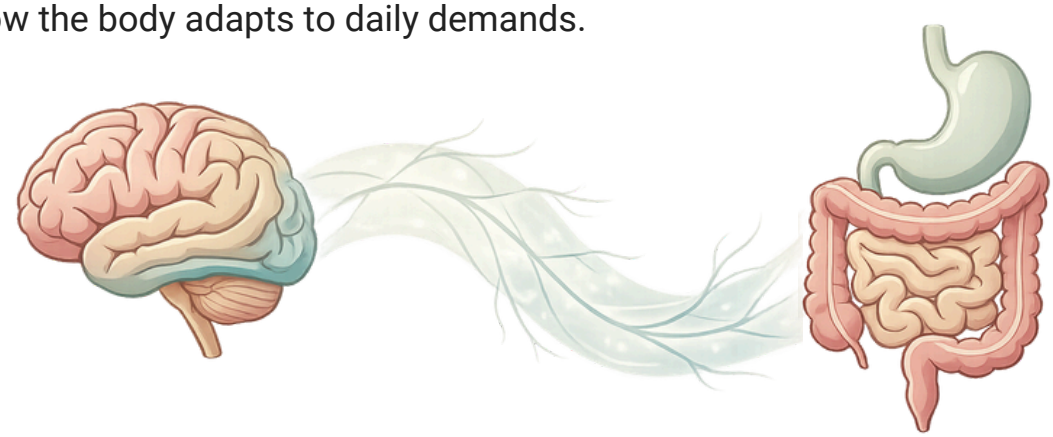
THE GUT–BRAIN CONNECTION

How your gut and brain communicate

The gut and brain are closely connected and constantly communicate with each other. This connection helps regulate digestion, appetite, and how the body responds to daily stress.

The gut environment can influence how you feel, while stress and emotions can affect digestion. Supporting both systems plays an important role in overall balance and well-being.

This connection works both ways, meaning that changes in one system can influence the other over time. For this reason, gut health is not only about digestion, but also about how the body adapts to daily demands.



How the brain affects the gut

Stress and emotions can influence digestion, gut sensitivity, and movement. This is why stress may lead to symptoms like bloating or discomfort.

How the gut affects the brain

The gut microbiome interacts with the nervous system and may influence mood, energy, and mental clarity. A balanced gut environment can support more stable daily well-being.

Why this connection matters

The gut–brain connection helps explain why digestive health and mental well-being are closely linked. When this communication is more balanced, it can support better daily comfort, steadier energy, and a more stable overall state.

SIGNS YOUR GUT MAY BE OUT OF BALANCE

Common signals that may reflect changes in digestion



Bloating

Frequent bloating, especially after meals, can be a sign that digestion is not working as smoothly as it should. It may also reflect changes in how food is being broken down or fermented in the gut.



Irregular Bowel Movements

Constipation, diarrhea, or alternating between both can be signs that the gut is out of balance. These changes may reflect shifts in motility, hydration, or the gut environment.



Food Sensitivities

If certain foods seem to trigger discomfort more often, the gut may need extra support. A sensitive digestive system can sometimes react more strongly when the gut barrier or microbiome is not functioning well.



Fatigue

Low energy can sometimes be linked to poor digestion and reduced nutrient absorption. When the gut is not functioning well, the body may not be using food as efficiently as it should.



Brain Fog

Trouble focusing or feeling mentally sluggish can be connected to gut health through the gut-brain axis. Changes in digestion, inflammation, or the microbiome may affect mental clarity.



Skin Flare-Ups

The skin and gut are closely connected through immune and inflammatory pathways. Ongoing breakouts, irritation, or increased sensitivity may sometimes reflect internal imbalance.

COMMON GUT DISRUPTORS

Everyday factors that can affect gut balance and digestion



Highly Processed Foods

Diets high in ultra-processed foods and added sugars can disrupt the gut microbiome. Over time, this may reduce beneficial bacteria.



Chronic Stress

Ongoing stress can affect digestion and the gut environment. It may also influence how the gut communicates with the brain.



Poor Sleep

Low-quality sleep can affect the microbiome and overall gut function. Regular, consistent sleep helps support repair, recovery, and internal balance.



Frequent Antibiotic Use

Antibiotics can reduce both harmful and beneficial bacteria. Repeated use may lower microbial diversity and temporarily disrupt gut balance.



Low Fiber Intake

Fiber helps feed beneficial gut bacteria. Diets low in fiber may reduce microbial diversity and limit daily digestive support.



Sedentary Lifestyle

Low activity levels can slow digestion and affect gut function. Regular movement helps support gut motility, circulation, and overall balance.

THE 5 PILLARS OF GUT HEALTH

How gut microbes support overall health



1. Fiber-Rich Nutrition

A gut-friendly diet starts with whole foods that provide fiber, variety, and key nutrients. Fiber helps feed beneficial gut bacteria and supports regular digestion.

2. Microbiome Support

The microbiome thrives on consistency, diversity, and the right daily inputs. Foods such as plants, fermented foods, and polyphenol-rich ingredients can help support a healthier gut environment.

3. Healthy Digestion

Gut health depends not only on what you eat, but also on how well your body digests and absorbs it. Eating slowly, chewing well, and supporting regular meals can help digestion work more efficiently.

4. Stress and Sleep Balance

The gut responds closely to the nervous system, making sleep and stress important parts of gut health. Ongoing stress or poor sleep can affect digestion, gut comfort, and overall balance.

5. Daily Movement

Regular movement helps support gut motility and overall digestive function. Even simple habits like walking can help keep the digestive system more active and balanced.



1. FIBER-RICH NUTRITION

Fiber-rich foods help support digestion and create a healthier environment for beneficial gut bacteria. Including a variety of fiber sources throughout the day can support gut balance and make meals more satisfying.

Different types of fiber support the gut in different ways, which is why variety matters more than relying on a single food. Building meals around whole plant foods can help increase fiber intake in a more natural and sustainable way.

Sources of dietary fiber

Good sources of fiber include oats, quinoa, lentils, chickpeas, beans, apples, pears, berries, leafy greens, carrots, broccoli, chia seeds, and flaxseeds. Including a mix of these foods regularly can help support a more balanced and diverse gut microbiome.

The role of fiber

- Supports regular digestion by helping food move more smoothly through the digestive tract
- Feeds beneficial gut bacteria and helps support overall microbiome balance
- Helps maintain a healthier and more stable gut environment over time
- Contributes to gut lining support through compounds produced during fermentation
- Supports fullness and more balanced meals
- Helps the body digest and use nutrients more effectively



2. MICROBIOME SUPPORT

The gut microbiome is a community of beneficial bacteria that plays a key role in digestion and overall gut health. Supporting this environment helps maintain balance and resilience over time.

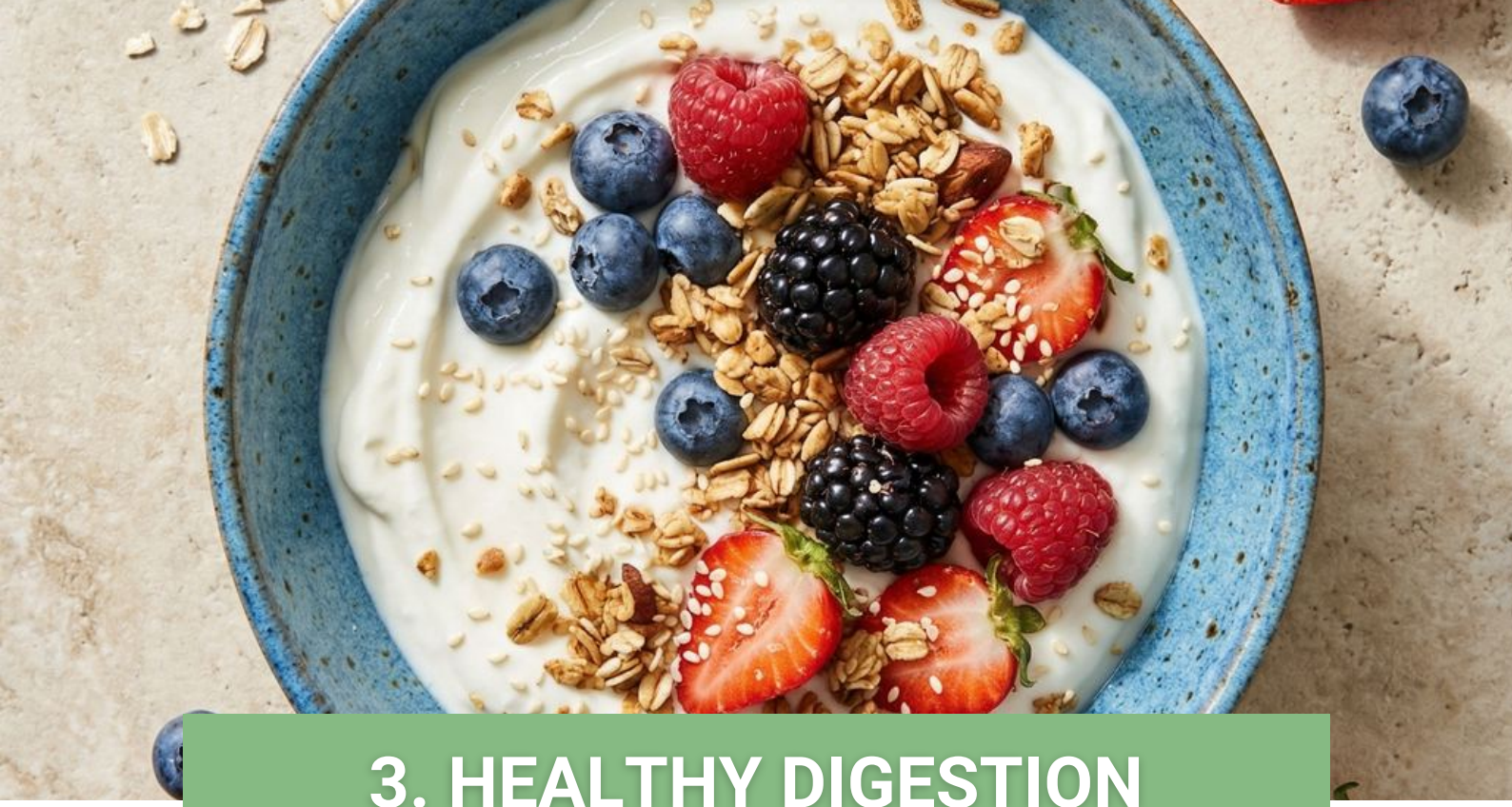
A diverse microbiome is often linked to better gut function, which is why daily habits and food variety can make a meaningful difference. The microbiome is shaped by what you eat regularly, not by one single food or choice.

Small, consistent habits such as adding more plant foods and including fermented foods can help create a more supportive gut environment. Because the microbiome responds over time, a simple routine built around variety, balance, and regular nourishment can help support long-term gut health.

Add fermented foods
Include foods like yogurt, kefir, sauerkraut, or kimchi.

Include polyphenol-rich foods
Berries, tea, herbs, and dark chocolate support beneficial bacteria.

Increase plant variety
A wider range of plant foods helps support microbiome diversity.



3. HEALTHY DIGESTION

Healthy digestion is not only about what you eat, but also how you eat. Simple habits can influence how well food is broken down and how comfortable you feel after meals. Eating too quickly, skipping meals, or overeating can place extra stress on the digestive system and affect how the body responds.

Daily routines such as eating pace, meal timing, and awareness during meals can support a smoother digestive process and reduce discomfort. These habits can also help the body better recognize hunger, fullness, and overall digestive comfort throughout the day.

DAILY HABITS THAT SUPPORT DIGESTION

Eat slowly
Taking time to eat can help support better digestion and reduce overeating.

Keep regular meals
Consistent meal timing helps support the body's natural digestive rhythm.

Chew thoroughly
Breaking food down well in the mouth supports the digestive process from the start.

Avoid distractions while eating
Eating without screens or multitasking can improve awareness and digestion.



4. STRESS AND SLEEP BALANC

Your gut responds to more than just food. Stress, sleep quality, and daily rhythms can directly influence how your digestive system works and how comfortable you feel.

When stress is higher or sleep is inconsistent, digestion may slow down or feel less efficient. Over time, this can affect gut balance and overall well-being.

When stress is high

Digestion may feel slower or more sensitive, which can lead to discomfort or changes in appetite.

When sleep is low

The body has less time to recover, which can affect digestion, energy levels, and daily balance.

WHAT TO FOCUS ON

- Create a simple evening routine: Winding down before bed can support both sleep quality and digestion.
- Keep a consistent sleep schedule: Going to bed and waking up at similar times helps regulate the body's rhythm.
- Include small stress breaks: Short pauses during the day can help reduce overall stress load.



5. DAILY MOVEMENT

WAYS TO SUPPORT DIGESTION WITH MOVEMENT

- Take short walks: A short walk after meals can help support digestion and reduce sluggishness.
- Avoid sitting for long periods: Regular movement breaks can help support circulation and digestive comfort.
- Include gentle daily activity: Walking, stretching, or light exercise can help keep the digestive system more active.
- Build movement into your routine: Small daily habits are often easier to maintain than occasional intense workouts.

Daily movement can help support gut health in simple but meaningful ways. It does not need to be intense to be helpful, and even light activity can make a difference when done consistently.

Small movement habits such as walking, stretching, and taking regular breaks from sitting can be easier to maintain over time. A steady routine often supports digestive comfort more effectively than occasional intense activity.

Benefits of daily movement

1. Supports gut motility and a steadier digestive rhythm
2. Helps reduce feelings of heaviness and sluggishness
3. Supports circulation and overall digestive comfort

GUT HEALTH RESET FRAMEWORK

A practical gut reset approach



Reduce Irritants
Limit foods and habits that may stress the gut



Support Digestion
Eat slowly and create consistent meal habits



Feed the Microbiome
Add fiber-rich and diverse plant foods



Restore Balance
Support sleep, stress, and daily recovery



Stay Consistent
Focus on simple habits you can maintain

HOW TO APPLY THE RESET

Start by choosing one area that feels easiest to improve. This could mean adding more fiber at meals, slowing down while eating, going to bed earlier, or taking a short walk after lunch or dinner.

As these habits begin to feel more natural, build on them gradually. The goal is not to follow every step perfectly, but to create a routine that supports digestion and feels realistic in daily life.

This method works best when you keep it simple and consistent. Small actions repeated often can do more for gut balance than trying to change everything at once.

Over time, these small changes can help create a steadier foundation for better digestion, improved daily comfort, and a more balanced gut environment.

Start with one or two simple habits that feel easy to apply in your daily routine. These steps are meant to work together, creating a more supportive routine for digestion and overall gut health.

GUT-FRIENDLY FOODS TO EAT MORE OFTEN

PREBIOTIC FOODS	**FIBER-RICH GRAINS**	**LEGUMES & PULSES**
		
Garlic, onions, leeks, asparagus	*Oats, quinoa, brown rice, barley*	*Lentils, chickpeas, black beans, peas*
FERMENTED FOODS	**LEAFY GREENS**	**COLORFUL VEGETABLES**
		
Yogurt, kefir, sauerkraut, kimchi	*Spinach, kale, arugula, Swiss chard*	*Carrots, bell peppers, broccoli, zucchini*
FRUITS	**POLYPHENOL-RICH FOODS**	**HEALTHY FATS**
		
Blueberries, strawberries, apples, pears	*Green tea, dark chocolate, berries, herbs*	*Olive oil, avocado, nuts, seeds*



FOODS THAT MAY TRIGGER SYMPTOMS

Common foods that may affect gut comfort

Highly Processed Foods

Ultra-processed foods often contain additives, refined sugars, and low fiber. These can disrupt gut balance and may contribute to bloating or discomfort.

High Sugar Foods & Drinks

Excess added sugar can influence the gut microbiome and promote imbalance. This may lead to increased gas, cravings, or digestive discomfort.

Fried & Greasy Foods

High-fat, heavily fried foods can be harder to digest for some people. They may slow digestion and contribute to feelings of heaviness or bloating.

Carbonated Drinks

Carbonation introduces gas into the digestive system. This may lead to bloating or increased abdominal pressure.

Dairy (for Some Individuals)

Some people may have difficulty digesting lactose found in dairy products. This can lead to symptoms such as bloating, gas, or discomfort.

Gluten-Containing Foods

For sensitive individuals, gluten may trigger digestive symptoms. This can include bloating, fatigue, or changes in bowel habits.

Artificial Sweeteners

Certain sugar substitutes may affect gut bacteria and digestion. In some cases, they can contribute to bloating or discomfort.

Alcohol

Alcohol can irritate the gut lining and affect microbial balance. Frequent intake may impact digestion and overall gut health.

DAILY HABITS FOR GUT BALANCE

Simple habits that support daily gut balance



- Start with one small habit and build from there
- Consistency matters more than perfection
- Simple daily actions can support long-term gut health

Eat with awareness

Slowing down and chewing well can support digestion and help reduce discomfort after meals. Eating with more awareness may also help you better notice hunger, fullness, and how your body responds to food.

Prioritize fiber daily

Including a variety of fiber-rich foods helps support beneficial gut bacteria and regular digestion. A steady intake of fiber can also help create a more balanced gut environment over time.

Stay hydrated

Drinking enough water supports digestion, nutrient absorption, and overall gut function.

Manage stress levels

Chronic stress can affect digestion and gut balance, making relaxation and recovery important.

Keep a consistent routine

Regular meal times and sleep patterns help support the body’s natural digestive rhythm.

Move your body daily

Light movement such as walking can support gut motility and overall digestive comfort.

BLOATING RELIEF QUICK GUIDE

Simple ways to ease everyday bloating

Bloating can feel like tightness, pressure, fullness, or swelling in the stomach area and is often linked to digestion, eating pace, certain foods, stress, or routine changes. While occasional bloating is common, frequent discomfort may be a sign that the gut needs more support.



WHAT TO TRY FIRST

- Eat more slowly and chew your food well to support smoother digestion.
- Take a short walk after meals to help reduce heaviness and support movement in the gut.
- Keep meals simple when digestion feels off to avoid extra strain on the system.
- Limit carbonated drinks, as they can increase gas and pressure.
- Pay attention to stress levels, as they can affect how your digestion feels.
- Stay consistent with meals and daily habits to support overall digestive comfort.

When to look closer

If bloating happens often, shows up with the same foods, or feels worse during stressful periods, it may help to track patterns. Repeated symptoms can offer useful clues about what your digestive system may be responding to.

7 DAYS TO RESET & REBUILD YOUR GUT

	FOCUS	DO THIS	ADJUST IF NEEDED
 **Day 1 Reset Your Foundation**	Reduce digestive load	Simplify meals: choose easy-to-digest foods (e.g., cooked veggies, rice, eggs, fish). Avoid ultra-processed foods and excess sugar.	If digestion feels sensitive, reduce portion size and prioritize softer, well-cooked foods.
 **Day 2 Support Hydration & Motility**	Improve gut movement	Start the day with a glass of warm water. Aim for consistent hydration throughout the day to support digestion and bowel regularity.	If bloating occurs, sip water slowly instead of drinking large amounts at once.
 **Day 3 Reintroduce Fiber Gradually**	Feed beneficial bacteria	Add gentle fiber sources like oats, chia seeds, or cooked vegetables. Focus on consistency, not large amounts.	If bloating increases, reduce fiber slightly and increase it more gradually.
 **Day 4 Add Gut-Friendly Foods**	Support microbiome balance	Include 1–2 gut-supportive foods such as yogurt, kefir, sauerkraut, or prebiotic foods like garlic and onions (if tolerated).	If sensitive to fermented foods, start with very small portions or choose lactose-free options.
 **Day 5 Stabilize Blood Sugar**	Reduce gut stress	Build balanced meals with protein, healthy fats, and fiber to avoid spikes and crashes that can impact digestion.	If energy dips, add a small balanced snack instead of extending time between meals.
 **Day 6 Support the Gut–Brain Axis**	Calm the nervous system	Add 10–15 minutes of relaxation (deep breathing, walking, or stretching). A calm nervous system supports digestion.	If breathing feels uncomfortable, choose gentle movement or quiet time instead.
 **Day 7 Build Consistency**	Reinforce sustainable habits	Combine the habits: simple meals, hydration, fiber, and mindful eating. Focus on consistency rather than perfection.	If overwhelmed, keep 2–3 core habits and build gradually over time.



FINAL THOUGHTS

Supporting gut health does not require perfect habits or major changes all at once. It is built through small, consistent actions that fit into your daily routine and feel realistic over time.

The goal is not to follow every step exactly, but to create a balanced approach that supports digestion, comfort, and overall well-being. Paying attention to how your body responds and adjusting gradually can make the process more sustainable.

There is no single way to support gut health, as individual needs can vary. What matters most is building a routine that works for you and feels manageable in everyday life.

Over time, these simple habits can help create a stronger foundation for long-term gut health. Consistency, variety, and a steady routine often make the biggest difference.

THANK YOU

Thank you for trusting Enchanted Medical Aesthetics with your gut health journey. Use this guide as your starting point, and bring your questions to your next visit. Our team is here to support you every step of the way.

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